

ARDMORE PARISH NEWSLETTER

Sunday, 13th September 2026

Twenty-Fourth Sunday in Ordinary Time

† Thoughts on the Gospel

Matthew 18:21-35

The gospel today tells of Peter asking Jesus how many times he should forgive someone who wrongs him. Jesus responds with a parable: a servant forgiven of an immense debt refuses to forgive a fellow servant of a small debt.

The lesson is clear: **those who receive mercy must extend mercy.**

Forgiveness begins with humility, recognising our own frailty and the mercy we have received. It is not weakness, but strength rooted in grace. Humility opens our hearts to God's mercy and enables us to extend that same mercy to others.

Forgiveness also requires empathy. By seeing the humanity of those who hurt us, we can respond with compassion without excusing wrongdoing. In forgiving, we honour the forgiveness we ourselves have received and become stewards of grace.

Ultimately, forgiveness reshapes our hearts, relationships, and communities, making us more like the One who forgives endlessly.

The parable of the unforgiving servant is not just a warning; it is an invitation. It calls us to live with a **HEART** shaped by **humility, empathy, accountability, release, and transformation.**

Forgiveness is not easy, but it is essential. When we forgive, we reflect the very heart of God. And in doing so, we discover freedom, peace, and the joy of a life lived in mercy.

Lord, help us forgive with humble hearts and share your mercy with others. Amen.



Installation of Bishop Michael Router

As the diocese prepares to celebrate the joyous occasion of the installation of **Bishop Router as Bishop of Derry on Sunday 20th September**, parishioners throughout the diocese are invited to participate in a **Triduum of Masses**, on **Friday 18th, Saturday 19th & Sunday 20th September**.

This is an important occasion for all of us in the diocese and people are invited to pray as a community or at home as a family or individually.

We invoke the intercession of the Holy Spirit and the words '**Come Holy Spirit**'. So too, we pray for the presence of Our Lady and protection of St Michael the Archangel and of course the intercession of St John Vianney and St Pio.

Readings for Sun 20th September

1st Reading: Isaiah 55:6-9

Psalm: 145:2-3, 8-9, 17-18

2nd Reading: Philippians 1:20c-24, 27a

Gospel: Matthew 20:1-16

Saints of the Coming Week

Monday: The Exultation of the Cross

Tuesday: Our Lady of Sorrows

Wednesday: St Cornelius, pope and St Cyprian, bishop, martyrs

Thursday: St Hildegard of Bingen, virgin and doctor of the Church, St Robert Bellarmine, bishop & doctor of the Church

Saturday: St Januarius, bishop & martyr

The Columban Young Adults

The Columban Young Adults are a new group for those aged **18 - 30** in the diocese, who are seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives.

Our September event will be a **Holy Hour and meditation on Thursday 17th September at 7.00 pm at Our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry**, delivered by Fr Declan McGeehan.

The meditation will be followed by Solemn Benediction and light refreshments.

We are actively seeking new members- **please come along and bring a friend!**

Eucharistic Adoration

Derry Diocese is renewing and developing its Diocesan Adoration Lay Committee to increase the practice of Eucharistic Adoration in parishes throughout the diocese.

You are welcome to an **Information Meeting on Wednesday 30th September at 8 pm** in the **Drummond Hotel, 2 Main St, Ballykelly, BT49 9HP**.

Registration / light refreshments from **7.30 pm**.

All welcome.

Job Opportunity

Derry Diocesan Trust invites applications for the post of **sacristan at Granaghan (Swatragh) parish**.

12 hrs per week

Rate of pay: £12.88 per hr.

Contact: recruitment@derrydiocese.org / 028 71262302

Closing date: 15th September 2026.

IE Human Life International Ireland

Fr L Carney (USA), international speaker and popular author, Provincial Tour of Ireland.

Join us for the **Ulster event at Canal Court Hotel, Newry on 29th Sept at 6:45pm** with 1st class relic of St Thérèse.

Season of Creation

Water heals, restores, and makes creation flourish, but it also challenges us to recognise ecological damage, embrace our interconnectedness, and immerse ourselves in the responsibility of caring for and restoring our Common Home.

May this season be a path for the healing of the earth and human well-being to flourish together.

Please visit: <https://youtu.be/xVVZ8LSpcRk>

Blessing of Bikers & Motorcycles

Blessing of Bikers & Motorcycles **today (Sunday) at 1.30 pm in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt.**

Following blessing all are welcome to join the run to **Ned's Point RNLI Station**, to present a donation to RNLI.

Mass will be celebrated on **13th September at 11.30 am in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN** for deceased bikers.

All welcome.



Coffee Morning — Foyle Hospice

Coffee Morning in aid of **Foyle Hospice** in **Murphy's on the Green on Friday 25th September from 9.30 am - 12.30 pm.**

Prize draw included at **£1 per line**. A great range of prizes up for grabs.

Draw at 1 pm on the day.

Hope to see you all there.



Queen's University Catholic Chaplaincy

Queen's University Catholic Chaplaincy reopens on **Monday 14th September**, with weekday Masses and our semester programme resuming.

The first Sunday Mass will be celebrated on **20th Sept at the earlier time of 7.00 pm.**

New or returning student? Find out about what's on, ways to connect and get involved, and student accommodation at Ryan Hall at **qubcatholic.org** and on our socials.

Staff and alumni are always welcome too.

Visit our newly renewed Chaplaincy at **28 Elmwood Ave** for Mass, Confessions or candle-lighting — and call into Mosaic for some of the best coffee, hot lunches and home-baked treats in South Belfast!



Michael English Church Concert

This evening of faith, hope and inspiration takes place on **Friday 2nd October at 7.15 pm**, in **St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin.**

Tickets: £30

Available at:

Heron's Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena Post Office, Ballinascreen and Desertmartin Parish offices, or online with Eventbrite:

<https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets1996641829460>

Lough Derg Day Retreats

September 15, 19, 20

A day of prayer, reflection and spiritual renewal.

Visit www.loughderg.org

All welcome.

Trócaire

Could you help share the true spirit of Christmas?

Each year, volunteers in parishes across Ireland set up a small stall after Masses to sell Trócaire's **Gifts of Change**: meaningful gifts that make a real difference to families living in poverty around the world.

We provide everything you need including training and support. All we ask is a little time and a big heart.

Last Christmas, **50 parishes took part — and we'd love to grow that number this year!**

If you would like to find out more, please email Mark at mark.mcmahon@trocaire.org or call **028 9080 8030**.

Safeguarding — Northern Ireland

If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Adult at risk of harm or Adult in need of protection within the Church please contact **Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP)** on:

07596 500793

marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org

To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact:

PSNI: 101

Western HSCT Children's Gateway Services: 028 71 314090